



Building a Better World
for All of Us®



MEETING NOTES

RE: Austin Comprehensive Plan
Planning Advisory Committee Meeting #8

Date of Meeting: June 10, 2025

Project Manager: Mark Nolan

Time of Meeting: 4:00 to 6:00 P.M.

SEH No.: 180253

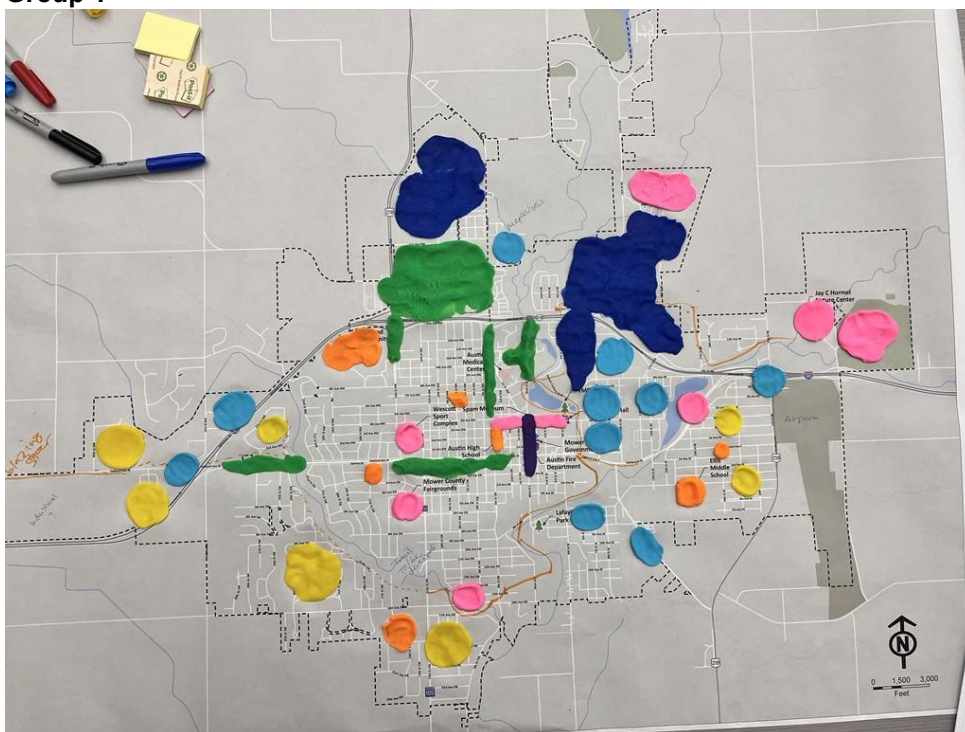
Location of Meeting: City Hall and Virtual via Teams

The following items were discussed at the above-referenced meeting (see attached presentation for additional reference):

- Schedule and Timeline Update
- Engagement survey #2 is now closed
 - A total of 220 responses
 - A complete summary of the survey is available on the [project website](#)
- **Review of DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies**
 - The group reviewed the following goals and strategies for economic development.
 - Goal 1. Adopt an integrated framework for planning and developing housing within the community.
 - Strategy 1.1: Continue to work with the Austin Housing and Redevelopment Authority (HRA) to advance housing objectives in collaboration with developers, financing entities, and housing organizations.
 - Strategy 1.2: Implement recommendations from the 2022 Housing Study as a foundation for city actions to address and improve housing supply and conditions.
 - Strategy 1.3: Update the Housing Study every five to ten years to maintain an accurate and up-to-date view of housing issues, potential solutions, and actions to improve housing conditions.
 - Strategy 1.4: Identify priority areas for residential infill and new housing developments.
 - Strategy 1.5: Align the city's zoning, policies, and subdivision ordinances to advance an appropriate mix of housing types within each district, as well as eliminate unnecessary barriers for housing development.
 - Strategy 1.6: Attract developers to build the types of housing projects the city is seeking and addresses community needs. Create marketing information that communicates the community's vision for new housing areas.
 - Strategy 1.7: New housing development should follow smart growth and infill development principles. Prioritize development in locations with existing infrastructure to reduce urban sprawl and impact on natural amenities.
 - Strategy 1.8: Partner with the Welcome Center and Adult Learning Center to provide accessible housing resources to Austin's diverse populations.
 - Goal 2. Austin's housing supply will include a broad range of housing types (this includes style, size, and cost) that meet the community's current and future needs.

- Strategy 2.1: Promote the development of a variety of housing types, including single-family, elder facilities, workforce housing, multi-family, life cycle, cooperative, townhouse and accessory dwelling housing options.
- Strategy 2.2: Identify and promote sites that could attract development of new market rate rental housing.
- Strategy 2.3: Identify opportunities for the development of workforce housing that can easily access industrial and commercial employment areas.
- Strategy 2.4: Identify opportunities for high density development at appropriate locations.
- Strategy 2.5: Promote the downtown area as an attractive and convenient place to live. Support funding programs that aim to modernize downtown building upper floors for housing purposes.
- Strategy 2.6: Proactively encourage the reuse and renovation of unused institutional and vacant buildings, upper floors, and underutilized properties that are compatible with residential uses.
- Goal 3. Preserve the character of neighborhoods that give Austin a sense of place.
 - Strategy 3.1: Protect neighborhoods from incompatible land uses through effective zoning and city code requirements.
 - Strategy 3.2: Regularly review existing ordinances that reduce blight and improve housing conditions.
 - **Comment:** The city is in the process of hiring a new inspector that will work on housing preservation and enforcement of housing codes.
 - Strategy 3.3: Establish standards and incentives guiding infill and new housing to match the character of the existing neighborhood.
 - Strategy 3.4: Encourage preservation of historically significant buildings in downtown and neighborhoods.
 - Strategy 3.5: Ensure that housing developments are accessible to community resources such as jobs, retail districts, walking, biking, and transit networks.
 - Strategy 3.6: Require pedestrian facilities, such as sidewalks and/or trails, as part of residential street reconstruction and new housing developments.
- Goal 4. Create a system for maintaining, protecting, and renovating the existing housing stock.
 - Strategy 4.1: Continue to identify, support, and promote programs that assist property owners with repairing, modernizing and weatherization activities.
 - Strategy 4.2: Encourage housing development to be constructed in an energy efficient and environmentally friendly manner.
 - Strategy 4.3: Expand and/or accelerate programs to rehabilitate and/or demolish blighted residential properties.
 - Strategy 5.1: Identify and promote methods for reducing residential lot costs to increase housing production.
 - Strategy 5.2: Support the development of new smaller detached homes.
 - Strategy 5.3: Support and use available programs to assist first-time home buyers and to attract potential residents.
 - Strategy 5.4: Update city zoning and ordinances that allow attached and detached accessory dwelling units on single-family lots in appropriate locations. Dwelling units should meet a code that provide livable conditions and match the neighborhood's character.
- Land Use
 - The project team facilitated a hand-on mapping activity that identified districts and character of land throughout the city. This activity helps to think about potential locations for development or improvements, or types of development and growth that may fit in specific areas. PAC members were separated into two groups and asked to identify the districts on a map of the city. The following images show the districts and characters labeled by each group:

■ Group 1



Character Districts in Austin

Group # 1

Please use clay, pens, stickers, or other items to indicate the character, districts, existing in Austin. There is no wrong answer! Please write the colors to identify each district you highlight.

Color or ID #	District or Character
BLUE	INDUSTRIAL
PINK	PARKS RECREATION NATURE CENTER
PURPLE	DOWNTOWN
GREEN	COMMERCIAL / RETAIL
LIGHT BLUE	NEEDS INVESTMENT
ORANGE	SCHOOL
YELLOW	RESIDENTIAL

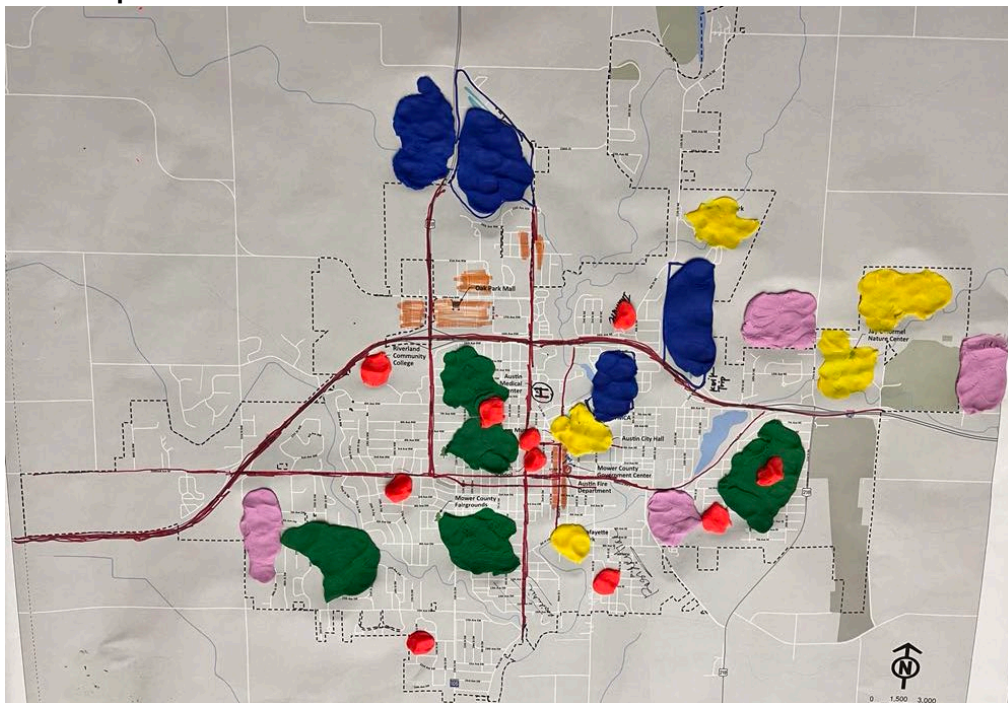
Character Districts in Austin

Group # 1

Please use clay, pens, stickers, or other items to indicate the character, districts, existing in Austin. There is no wrong answer! Please write the colors to identify each district you highlight.

Color or ID #	District or Character
Fun areas	Pink
Business areas	Green
recreation by Ketchikan to visit	
Industrial	Blue
main st main st	Purple
Needs investment	or redevelopment 1. blue
Res.	Residential
Schools	
M.K. Sing. rec. trails	

- **Group A**



Character Districts in Austin

Please use clay, pens, stickers, or other items to indicate the character, districts, existing in Austin. There is no wrong answer! Please write the colors to identify each district you highlight.

Group # A

Color or ID #	District or Character
red	Major roadways
Blue	Industrial
Orange	Retail
Green	Residential
Purple	Residential growth
Yellow	Nature/Parks
light red	Schools

- **Review of DRAFT Land Use Goals**
 - The group reviewed the following goals for land use
 - Goal 1. Provide a range of land use types and the most appropriate locations for development and redevelopment.
 - Goal 2. Maintain and enhance Austin's distinctive character, unique identity, and physical image.
 - Goal 3. Plan for the orderly, efficient and fiscally responsible growth and development within the community.
 - Goal 4. Identify, evaluate, and preserve natural resources prior to designating areas for development.
 - Goal 5. Encourage the continuing evolution of downtown as a vital mixture of commercial, residential, and civic uses.
 - Goal 6. Value, preserve, and maintain historic properties, documents and historic sites.
 - Goal 7. Encourage development of housing and increase the livability of residential districts.
 - Goal 8. Support the conservation of prime agricultural lands.
- **Plan Outline**
 - The project team presented an outline of chapters for the Comprehensive Plan, listed as followed:
 - Chapter 1. Intro: Purpose and Background
 - Chapter 2. Community Profile
 - Chapter 3. Community Engagement

- Chapter 4. Housing
- Chapter 5. Economic Development
- Chapter 6. Transportation
- Chapter 7. Public Utilities and Community Facilities
- Chapter 8. Parks and Open Spaces
- Chapter 9. Land Use
- Chapter 10. Implementation
- The 2045 Comprehensive Plan will include topics outside a traditional plan. This plan will incorporate the following elements: Local and regional food movement, tourism and recreation, sustainability and resiliency, downtown development, and technology.
- The project team has started developing the formatted version of the Comprehensive Plan. It asked PAC members to share photos that will be used in the plan.
- Introduction to Implementation
 - The implementation chapter will serve as a guide to implementing the strategies and recommendations presented by each chapter. Implementation will identify key champions and responsible parties for each goal and strategy.
- Next Steps
 - Present goals and strategies for land use
 - A draft of the Velocity Team Playbook will be available soon
 - Next PAC meeting on July 17

If changes or additions are needed in this document, or if relevant information has been omitted, please contact Project Manager, Mark Nolan at mnolan@sehinc.com.

Attendees:

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| • Holly Wallace | • Diane Baker |
| • Steve Kime | • Craig Clark |
| • Pat Wegner | • Kathleen Linaker |
| • Lindsey Compton | • Adrian Diaz |
| • Nick Novotny | • Mark Nolan |

Planning Advisory Committee (PAC) Meeting #8

June 10, 2025





Agenda

- Project Schedule
- Survey #2 – Now Closed
- Housing
- Land Use
- Plan Outline
- Next Steps





Project Schedule



Schedule and Milestones

Project Schedule																
	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan
PAC Meetings	1	2		3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12			
Task 3: Development of 2045 Comprehensive Plans																
Introduction (Role and Purpose)																
Vision Statement																
Sustainability (Environmental, Financial, and Long-Term)																
Transportation																
Parks and Open Space																
Community Facilities and Utilities																
Economic Development and Tourism																
Housing																
Land Use																
Implementation																

City-only meeting

Joint City and County Meeting

We are here



Survey Summary

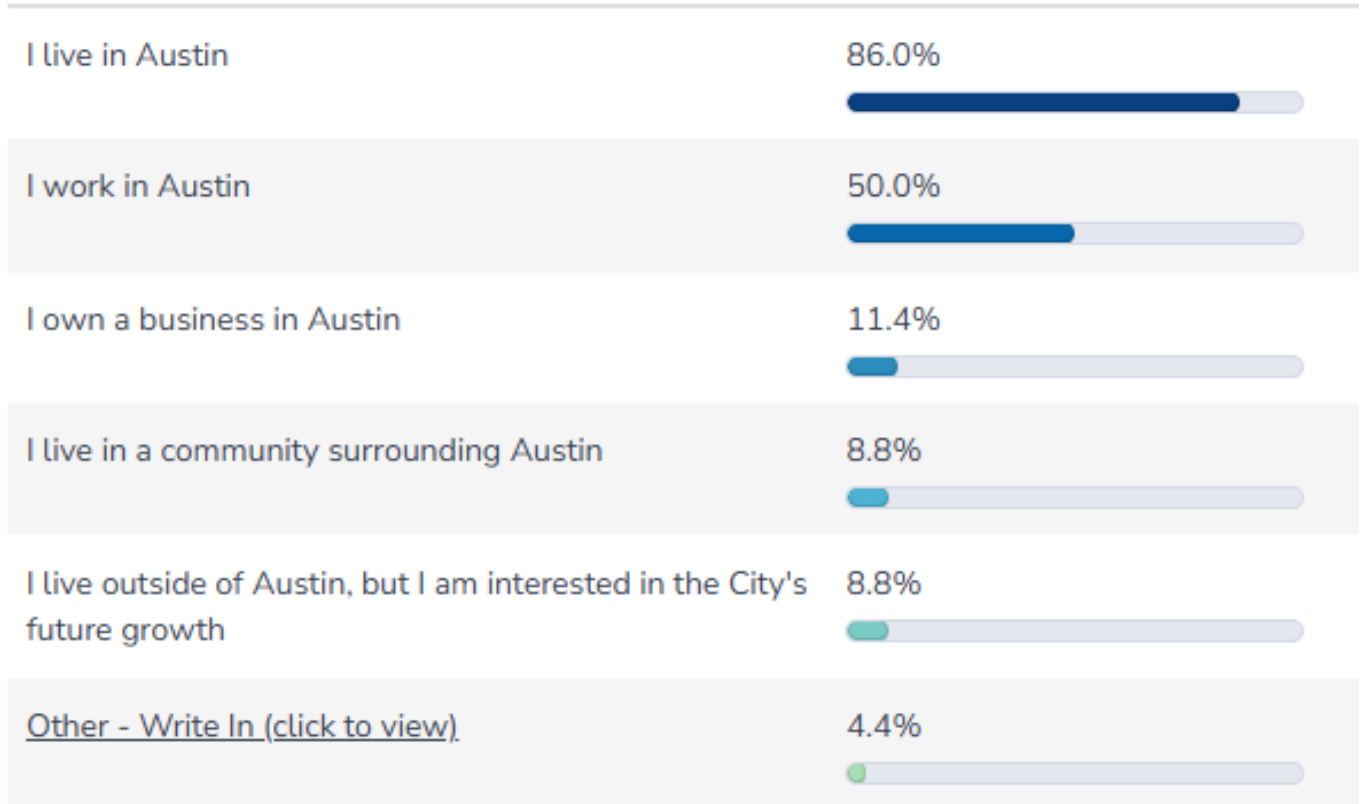


Survey #2 – NOW CLOSED



220 survey participants
(119 complete, 101 partial)

[Click here to view a final summary of the Austin survey #2](#)





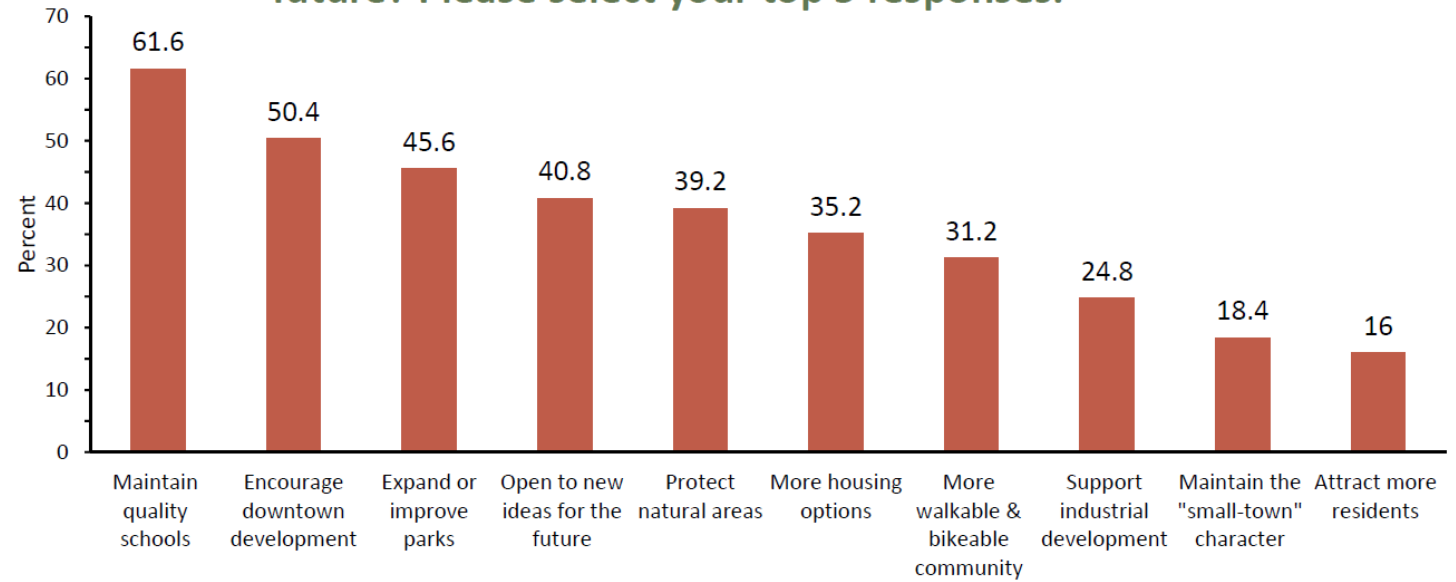
Survey #2 – NOW CLOSED

COMPREHENSIVE
PLAN
2045



Phase 2 Community Survey Engagement Summary - June 2025

2. What should be the City's top priorities for the future? Please select your top 5 responses.



This only shows the top 10 choices selected



Housing



DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

1. Adopt an integrated framework for planning and developing housing within the community.

- Strategy 1.1: Continue to work with the Austin Housing and Redevelopment Authority (HRA) to advance housing objectives in collaboration with developers, financing entities, and housing organizations.
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- Strategy 1.4: Identify priority areas for residential infill and new housing developments.



DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

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DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

1. Adopt an integrated framework for planning and developing housing within the community.

- Strategy 1.8: Partner with the Welcome Center and Adult Learning Center to provide accessible housing resources to Austin's diverse populations.



DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

2. Austin's housing supply will include a broad range of housing types (this includes style, size, and cost) that meet the community's current and future needs.

- Strategy 2.1: Promote the development of a variety of housing types, including single-family, elder facilities, workforce housing, multi-family, life cycle, cooperative, townhouse and accessory dwelling housing options.
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DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

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- Strategy 2.5: Promote the downtown area as an attractive and convenient place to live. Support funding programs that aim to modernize downtown building upper floors for housing purposes.
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DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

3. Preserve the character of neighborhoods that give Austin a sense of place.

- Strategy 3.1: Protect neighborhoods from incompatible land uses through effective zoning and city code requirements.
- Strategy 3.2: Regularly review existing ordinances that reduce blight and improve housing conditions.
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DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

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- Strategy 3.6: Require pedestrian facilities, such as sidewalks and/or trails, as part of residential street reconstruction and new housing developments.



DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

4. Create a system for maintaining, protecting, and renovating the existing housing stock.

- Strategy 4.1: Continue to identify, support, and promote programs that assist property owners with repairing, modernizing and weatherization activities.
- Strategy 4.2: *Encourage housing development to be constructed in an energy efficient and environmentally friendly manner.*
- Strategy 4.3: Expand and/or accelerate programs to rehabilitate and/or demolish blighted residential properties.



DRAFT Housing Goals and Strategies

5. Support the planning and construction of affordable housing options.

- Strategy 5.1: Identify and promote methods for reducing residential lot costs to increase housing production.
- Strategy 5.2: Support the development of new smaller detached homes.
- Strategy 5.3: Support and use available programs to assist first-time home buyers and to attract potential residents.
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Land Use



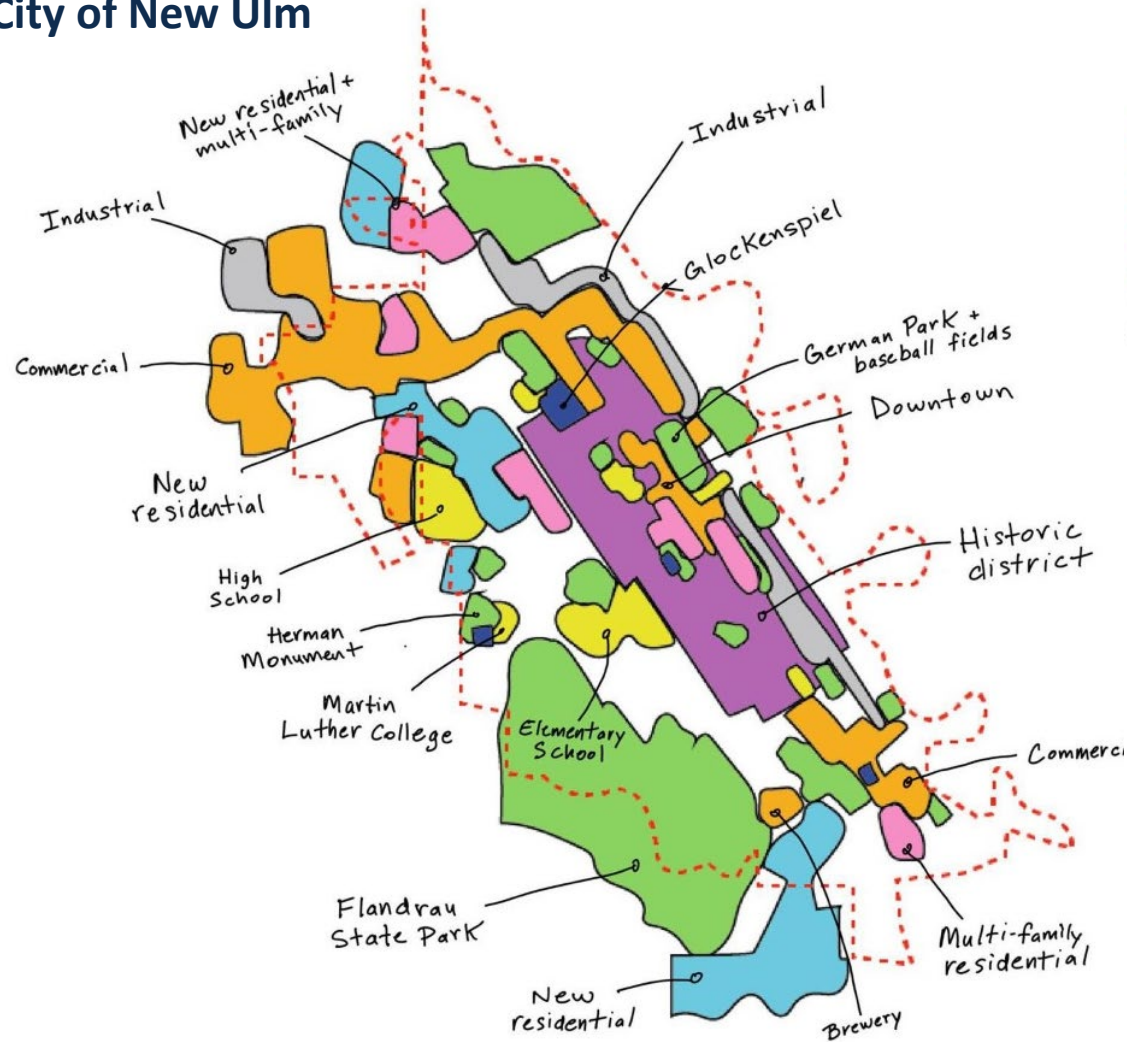
City Districts Activity



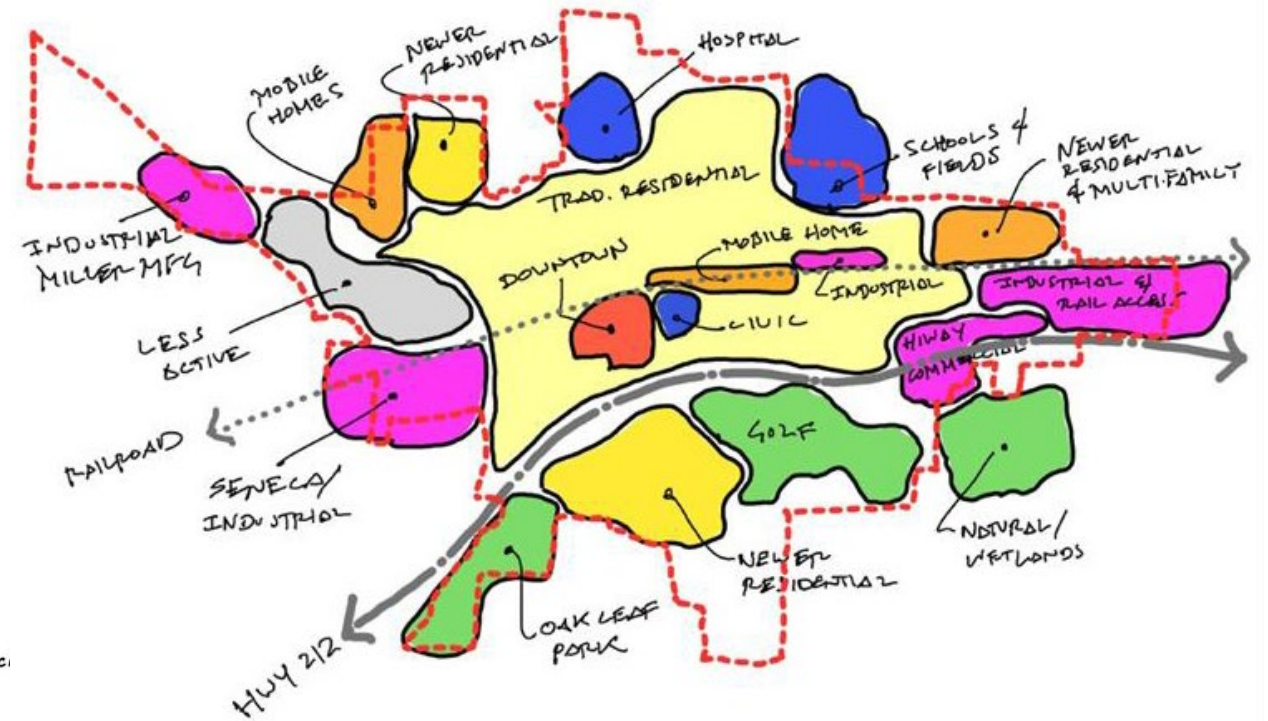


City Districts Activity

City of New Ulm



City of Glencoe





City Districts Activity



District or areas that define Austin

- What are important locations?
- What areas are residential? Parks or open spaces? Industrial? Commercial? Public spaces? Others?

What areas have potential for different development or growth?



Connecting routes

- What are major road connectors?
- Major trails and sidewalks?
- Railroads?
- Others?



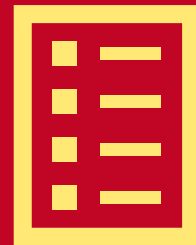
DRAFT Land Use Goals

- 1. Provide a range of land use types and the most appropriate locations for development and redevelopment.**
- 2. Maintain and enhance Austin's distinctive character, unique identity, and physical image.**
- 3. Plan for the orderly, efficient and fiscally responsible growth and development within the community.**
- 4. Identify, evaluate, and preserve natural resources prior to designating areas for development.**



DRAFT Land Use Goals

- 5. Encourage the continuing evolution of downtown as a vital mixture of commercial, residential, and civic uses.**
- 6. Value, preserve, and maintain historic properties, documents and historic sites.**
- 7. Encourage development of housing and increase the livability of residential districts.**
- 8. Support the conservation of prime agricultural lands.**



Plan Outline



Plan Outline

1. Intro: Purpose and Background
2. Community Profile
3. Community Engagement
4. Housing
5. Economic Development
6. Transportation
7. Public Utilities and Community Facilities
8. Parks and Open Spaces
9. Land Use
10. Implementation





Plan Outline

Chapters will also incorporate additional topics and elements:

- Local and regional food movement
- Tourism and recreation
- Sustainability and resiliency
- Downtown development
- Technology





Plan Outline



COMPREHENSIVE PLAN

DRAFT



CHAPTER 1 INTRODUCTION PURPOSE AND VISION

2. Community Profile

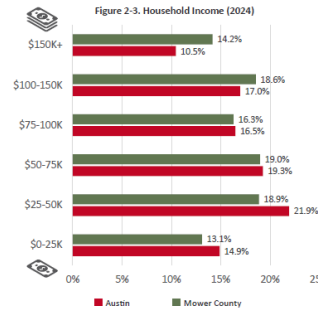
Income

In 2024, the median household income in Austin was estimated to be \$64,899. By 2030, the median household income is expected to increase 15.8% to \$75,143. The average annual increase (3.2%) will outpace the historical annual inflation rate of 2.6% over the past ten years. Household income for Austin and Mower County residents is detailed in Table 2-8 and Figure 2-3.

Table 2-8. Household Income (2024)

Income	City of Austin		Mower County	
	Number	%	Number	%
Less than \$15,000	799	7.7%	1,140	7.1%
\$15,000 to \$24,999	741	7.2%	958	6.0%
\$25,000 to \$34,999	768	7.4%	995	6.2%
\$35,000 to \$49,999	1,502	14.5%	2,028	12.7%
\$50,000 to \$74,999	1,996	19.3%	3,041	19.0%
\$75,000 to \$99,999	1,707	16.5%	2,610	16.3%
\$100,000 to \$149,999	1,756	17.0%	2,971	18.6%
\$150,000 to \$199,999	601	5.8%	1,249	7.8%
\$200,000 or more	481	4.6%	1,022	6.4%
Median HH Income	\$64,899		\$73,206	
Per Capita Income	\$32,890		\$36,784	

Source: 2024 American Community Survey 5-Year Estimates



Nu-Tek building in Austin

20 | Austin Comprehensive Plan

A Vision for Austin's Future

The City of Austin is a vibrant and diverse community offering a rich blend of culture, education, and nature. It is a place where people are connected by a strong sense of community and history. It fosters innovation, inclusivity and tradition, making it ideal to live, visit, work, and start a business residents.

The Plan's Vision is a statement that describes the Austin's future after the plan's recommendations are implemented. It was developed from the comments, priorities, and ideas gathered through a transparent community engagement process and refined through work with the Project Advisory Committee (PAC).

8 | Austin Comprehensive Plan



Plan Outline

We need your help gathering high-quality photos to include in the comprehensive plan.

PLEASE SAVE PHOTOS IN A FOLDER FOR EACH CHAPTER:
https://sehincazure-my.sharepoint.com/:f:/g/personal/adiaz_sehinc_com/EjhHaPZ9R5tFmtjyfoMldrABhwG3lggEsyLZpP3eOMipYQ?e=YSBrjM

Share Copy link Download Automate

My files > 00_Projects > AMC Comprehensive Plans > City of Austin Photos for Comp Plan - Please add Pho

Name	Modified
01_Other photos - please describe in title with a few words	May 22
02_Community profile - schools, festivals, natural spaces, city hall, college,	May 22
03_Engagement - community events	May 22
04_Land Use - farming, commercial areas, downtown, neighborhoods, industrial areas, rural roads, constru...	May 22
05_Housing and Neighborhoods - single family, apartments, condos, townhomes, construction, etc	May 22
06_Transportation - Cars, road, sidewalks, bikers, people walking, trails	
08_Parks and Rec - parks, trails, green spaces, vegetation, sport fields, rec centers, YMCA, rivers	May 22
09_Community Facilities and Utilities - Rec centers, city hall, police, fire, monuments, utility centers, wastew...	May 22
10_implementation - city hall meetings, historical photos, community engagement	May 22



Next Steps

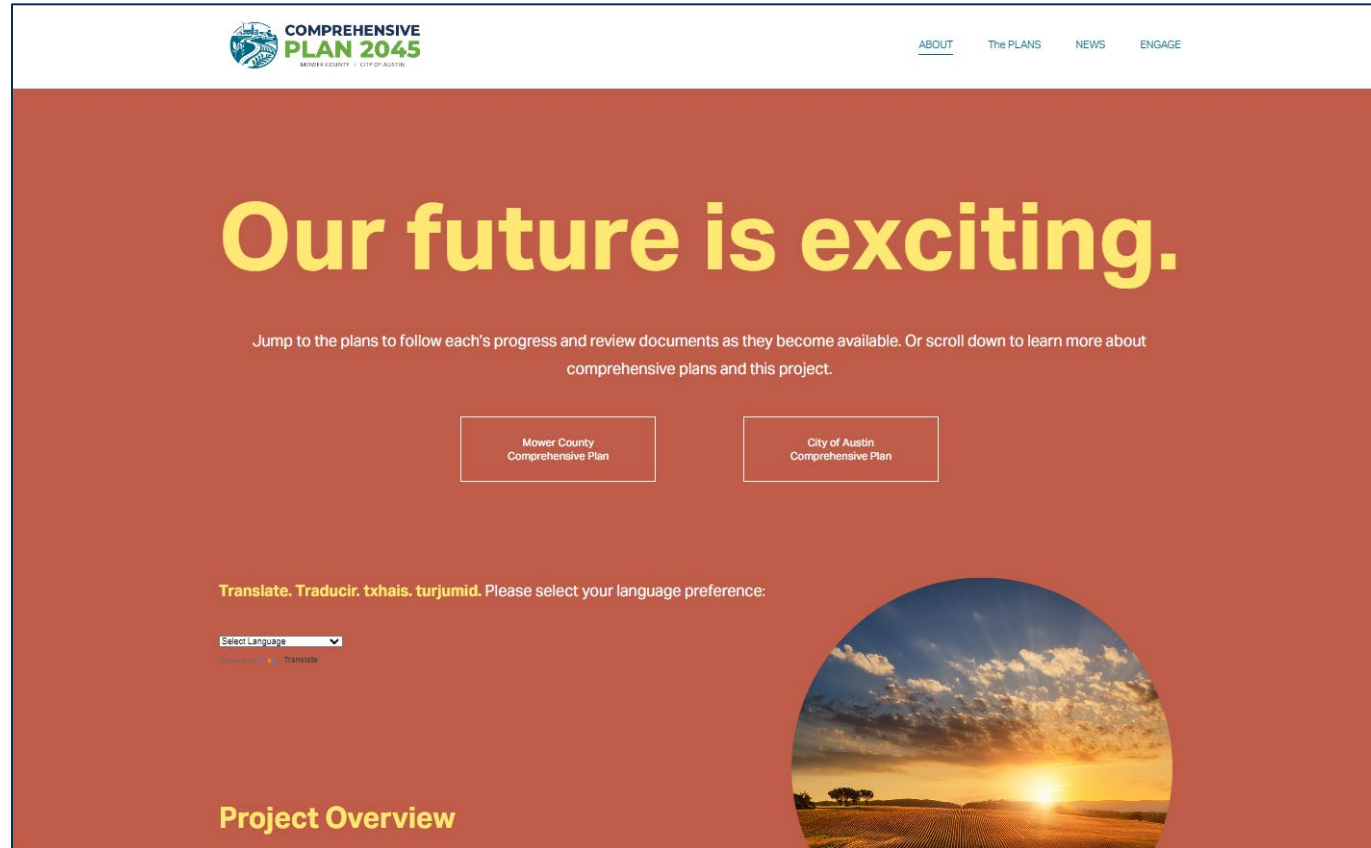


Next Steps

- **Draft Goals and Strategies**
 - **Land Use**
- **Velocity Team “Playbook”**
- **Next PAC Meeting: July 17 (virtual)**



For more information



Visit the project website:

<https://www.compplan2045.com/>



Let's Plan Our Future.